FUTURE VISION

Institute for Computer & Languages

LEVEL

3

C1.1
CEFR

Advanced

The English of talks, decisions, and public life

Future Vision English Course

STUDENT BOOK

Student Name _____

Teacher _____

Group / Time _____

Month _____

STORIES · NEWS · PODCASTS · CONVERSATIONS

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STORY · LESSON 1

The Talk in Cairo

Sara arrives in Cairo to give the most important talk of her life, but her laptop is still on the plane. Read the story, then read it from the point of view of a journalist in the audience.

- Join ideas with participle clauses
- Tell a story in a formal style
- Talk about turning a problem into a chance

1 The story

Having landed in Cairo at two in the afternoon, Sara took a taxi straight to the conference center. Her talk on solar water pumps was at five, and she had spent three weeks preparing it. Everything was on her laptop, forty slides, photos of the village, and a short video of the pump.

Arriving at her hotel, she opened her bag to check her notes. Her laptop wasn't there. **Her heart sank**. **Thinking** back, she could see it clearly, in the seat pocket on the plane, exactly where she had left it.

She called the airline. The plane had already left for Dubai. **Not knowing** what else to do, she called Omar. "Do you have a copy of the slides?" she asked. "No," he said. "But you don't need slides. You need the story. You were there."

Left with only a pen and a notebook, Sara sat in a café near the conference center and wrote five words on a page. Water. Walk. Sun. Flood. People. **Encouraged** by Omar, she decided to **make the most of** it.

At five o'clock, she walked onto the stage. The screen behind her was empty. "I was going to show you forty slides," she began, "but my laptop is flying to Dubai without me." The audience laughed, and she relaxed.

Then she told them a story. She told them about the women who used to walk two hours a day for water, and about the morning the pump started. She told them about the night the river rose, when the batteries from the pump lit the school. **Speaking** without slides, she looked at the audience, not at a screen, and the audience looked back.

The Talk in Cairo (continued)

1 The story (continued)

When she finished, there was a moment of silence, and then the whole room stood up and clapped. **Asked** later by a journalist about her missing laptop, Sara smiled. "**Every cloud has a silver lining**," she said. "With my slides, I would have talked to a screen. Without them, I talked to people."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **When did Sara land in Cairo?**
At two in the afternoon.

2 **What was her talk about?**
Solar water pumps.

3 **How long had she spent preparing it?**
Three weeks.

4 **What did she find when she opened her bag?**
Her laptop wasn't there.

5 **Where had she left the laptop?**
In the seat pocket on the plane.

6 **Where was the plane going?**
To Dubai.

7 **What did Omar say she needed?**
The story, not slides.

8 **What five words did she write?**
Water, walk, sun, flood, and people.

9 **How did she begin her talk?**
"I was going to show you forty slides, but my laptop is flying to Dubai without me."

10 **What did she tell the audience about?**
The women who walked for water, the morning the pump started, and the night the river rose.

11 **What did the audience do when she finished?**
They stood up and clapped.

12 **Why does Sara think losing the laptop was good?**
Without her slides, she talked to people, not to a screen.

The Talk in Cairo (continued)

3 Point of view

Now Rania, a journalist, tells it.

R

I have reported on conferences for ten years, and most talks are the same. **Having seen** hundreds of slides, I usually sit at the back and check my phone.

That afternoon, a young engineer walked onto the stage with nothing in her hands. **Seeing** the empty screen, I expected a disaster. Instead, she made us laugh in the first ten seconds.

Listening to her, I forgot to take notes. She talked about real people, and she spoke as if she were telling the story to friends.

Asked by my editor which talk was the best of the conference, I didn't need to think. It was the one with no slides at all.

4 What did you learn?

You learned participle clauses.

They make sentences shorter and more formal. The subject of the clause is the same as the subject of the main sentence.

PARTICIPLE CLAUSE	WHAT IT MEANS
Having landed, she took a taxi.	After she had landed, …
Arriving at her hotel, she…	When she arrived at her hotel, …
Not knowing what to do, she…	Because she didn't know what to do, …
Left with only a pen, she…	Because she was left with only a pen, …
Asked about her laptop, she…	When she was asked about it, …

The Talk in Cairo (continued)

4 What did you learn? (continued)

-ing: active, at the same time
Speaking without slides, she looked at the audience.

Having + past participle: before
Having seen hundreds of talks, I sat at the back.

Past participle: passive
Encouraged by Omar, she decided to try.

QUESTIONS **What do you usually do, having finished a long day?**

Having finished work, I usually drink tea with my family.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

your heart sinks

you suddenly feel sad or worried

Example: *When I saw the long line at the bank, my heart sank.*

PHRASE

make the most of something

to use a situation as well as you can, even when it is not perfect

Example: *It rained all week, but we made the most of it and visited the museums.*

PROVERB

Every cloud has a silver lining.

Something good can come from even a bad situation.

Example: *I lost my job, but I found a better one. Every cloud has a silver lining.*

6 New words

slides	pages that are shown on a screen during a talk	**stage**	the raised place where a speaker stands
audience	the people who watch or listen to a talk	**relaxed**	became calm and less nervous
journalist	a person who writes news for a newspaper or website	**editor**	the person who decides what a newspaper prints

TOPIC · LESSON 2

How to Give a Great Talk

Most people are afraid of speaking in public. A few simple steps can make any talk better.

Talk about public speaking | Give advice in a clear order | Use participle clauses in advice

1 Read

Many people say that they are more afraid of **public speaking** than of spiders, snakes, or flying. Their hearts beat fast, their hands shake, and their minds go blank. But giving a good talk is a skill, and like any skill, it can be learned.

Start with your **audience**. Who are they, and what do they need to know? Having answered that question, choose one main message. A talk with ten messages is remembered for none of them.

Next, build your talk around a **story**. People forget numbers and lists, but they remember stories, especially true ones about real people. Begin with something that will **break the ice**, a question, a surprising fact, or a little humor, and then **get to the point** quickly.

Use **slides** carefully. A slide should show a picture or a few words, not a page of text. If the audience is reading, they are not listening. And always be ready to speak without them, because technology fails more often than you think.

Finally, practice aloud, not just in your head. Record yourself on your phone and time your talk. Speak more slowly than feels natural, and pause after important points. Look at people, not at the screen or the floor.

Being nervous is normal, even for experienced speakers. The trick is not to stop the fear but to use it. Having prepared well, you will find that a little fear gives you energy instead of taking it away.

2 Four steps to a great talk

1. **Audience** — who are they, and what do they need?
2. **Message** — choose one main idea
3. **Story** — build the talk around real people
4. **Practice** — aloud, with a timer

How to Give a Great Talk (continued)

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What are many people more afraid of than spiders?**
Public speaking.

2 **What should you think about first?**
Your audience.

3 **Why should a talk have only one main message?**
A talk with ten messages is remembered for none of them.

4 **Why should you build a talk around a story?**
People forget numbers and lists, but they remember stories.

5 **What should a slide show?**
A picture or a few words.

6 **How should you practice?**
Aloud, recording yourself and timing the talk.

7 **What does a little fear give you?**
Energy.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

break the ice

to say or do something that helps people relax at the start

Example: *Our teacher broke the ice on the first day with a funny game.*

PHRASE

get to the point

to talk about the most important thing without wasting time

Example: *We only have five minutes, so please get to the point.*

5 New words

blank	empty, with no ideas	**skill**	something you can do well because you have learned it
humor	the quality of being funny	**pause**	stop for a short time
experienced	having done something many times	**energy**	the power and strength to do things

CONVERSATION · LESSON 3

Questions From the Audience

Answering questions clearly and honestly after a talk

Welcome and answer questions | Say that you will check a fact | Close a question time politely

1 Read the conversation

After her talk in Cairo, Sara takes questions from the audience. Dr. Kamal, a professor of engineering, and Rania, a journalist, ask her questions.

DK DR. KAMAL	Thank you for a wonderful talk. How much does one pump cost, and who pays for it?
S SARA	That's a great question. The whole system cost less than a small car. This time, the money came from our university and a local business.
DK DR. KAMAL	And what happens when something breaks? Who repairs it?
S SARA	We trained two young people from the village to look after it. Having learned the basics, they can fix most problems themselves.
R RANIA	Could this work in other countries, too?
S SARA	I believe so, especially where there's a lot of sun and the water isn't too deep. But I'd rather not guess the numbers. Let me **get back to you** on that after I check.
R RANIA	Of course. And what was the hardest part of the project?
S SARA	Honestly, it wasn't the engineering. It was listening. We had to understand what the village needed before we built anything.
DK DR. KAMAL	That's certainly **food for thought** for all of us engineers.
S SARA	Thank you. If there are no more questions, I'll be outside if anyone would like to talk.

2 Useful phrases

WELCOME A QUESTION
That's a great question.

GIVE A CLEAR ANSWER
The whole system cost less than a small car.

SAY THAT YOU WILL CHECK
Let me get back to you on that after I check.

BE CAREFUL WITH FACTS
I'd rather not guess the numbers.

ANSWER HONESTLY
Honestly, it wasn't the engineering. It was listening.

CLOSE THE QUESTIONS
If there are no more questions, I'll be outside.

Questions From the Audience (continued)

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

get back to someone

to answer someone later, when you have more information

Example: *I don't know the price yet, but I'll get back to you tomorrow.*

IDIOM

food for thought

an idea that makes you think carefully

Example: *His talk about saving water gave us all food for thought.*

4 New words

local	from the area near you	**trained**	taught someone the skills for a job
basics	the simplest and most important things to know	**engineering**	the work of designing and building machines and structures
honestly	telling the truth	**certainly**	without any doubt

STORY · LESSON 4

The Night the River Rose

A sudden flood cuts off the village where Sara's team built its solar pump. Read the story, then read it from the point of view of an engineer on her team.

Give emphasis with inversion | Tell a dramatic story | Describe how people work together in a crisis

1 The story

Sara had visited the village near Kassala many times since her team built the solar pump, but she had never seen the sky like this. **Never had** the old men of the village **seen** so much rain in one afternoon. By evening, the Gash River, which is dry for most of the year, had become a brown, roaring wall of water.

The Night the River Rose (continued)

1 The story (continued)

Not only did the river **rise** faster than anyone expected, but the road to Kassala was also **cut off** within an hour. Fifty families lived on the low side of the village, close to the water. Sara, Tarig, and Mona ran from house to house, telling people to move to the school, which stood on higher ground.

Hardly had the last family **reached** the school **when** the water poured into the empty streets behind them. Two hundred people were crowded into four classrooms, most of them wet and frightened. Then a woman ran to Sara. "My father needs his heart medicine," she said, "and it's in our house." The house was already under water.

Sara called the one person she knew who could get medicine through a flood. Omar's company had spent a year testing drones that carry medicine to villages. "Give me two hours," he said. "Keep your phone on."

Only then did Sara **realize** how tired she was, but there was no time to rest. Mona kept the children calm with games and stories. Tarig connected the batteries from the pump to the school, so the classrooms had light all night. The women cooked rice in the yard, and the men carried clean water from the pump's tank. Everyone had a job. "**Many hands make light work**," said one of the old men.

At two in the morning, they heard a soft buzzing above the school. A small drone came down out of the darkness and landed in the yard with a box. Inside were the medicine, some bandages, and a note. From Omar's Technology. With an H this time. Sara laughed for the first time that night.

By the next afternoon, the water had gone down, and a Red Crescent truck arrived. **Never before had** the village **felt** so close. "You were **a ray of hope** for us," the woman told Sara. Sara shook her head and pointed at the people in the yard. "No," she said. "We all were."

The Night the River Rose (continued)

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Where was Sara?**
In the village near Kassala, where her team had built the solar pump.

2 **What had the old men never seen?**
So much rain in one afternoon.

3 **What did the Gash River become?**
A brown, roaring wall of water.

4 **What happened to the road to Kassala?**
It was cut off within an hour.

5 **Where did the families go?**
To the school, which stood on higher ground.

6 **What happened as soon as the last family reached the school?**
The water poured into the empty streets behind them.

7 **What did the woman's father need?**
His heart medicine.

8 **Who did Sara call?**
Omar.

9 **How did the classrooms have light all night?**
Tarig connected the batteries from the pump to the school.

10 **When did the drone arrive?**
At two in the morning.

11 **What did the note say?**
From Omar's Technology. With an H this time.

12 **What did Sara say when the woman thanked her?**
"We all were."

3 Point of view

Now Mona tells it.

MO

I have worked on many projects, but **never have I been** as frightened as I was that night. The rain didn't stop for six hours, and the river rose faster than any of us expected.

My job was the children. More than eighty of them were in one classroom, terrified of the noise, so we played games and sang until they fell asleep. **Not once did** they **stop** asking about their homes.

Little did we **know** that Omar was already on his way. When his drone landed in the yard, the children who were still awake started cheering, and the ones who were asleep woke up.

Only later did I **understand** what we had done. Nobody had been hurt, and every family had a dry place to sleep.

The Night the River Rose (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned inversion for emphasis.

After a negative or limiting word at the start of a sentence, the auxiliary verb comes before the subject, as in a question. It sounds formal and dramatic.

NORMAL WORD ORDER	WITH INVERSION
The village had never seen such rain.	**Never had** the village **seen** such rain.
The river rose, and the road closed too.	**Not only did** the river **rise**, but…
As soon as they arrived, the water came.	**Hardly had** they **arrived when** it came.
She realized it only then.	**Only then did** she **realize** it.
We didn't know he was coming.	**Little did** we **know** he was coming.

Word + auxiliary + subject
Never have I seen… Rarely do we hear… Not once did they stop…

Past simple: add did
The river rose. Not only did the river rise…

Use it carefully
It is dramatic. In everyday speech, normal word order is better.

QUESTIONS **What have you never seen in your life?** Never have I seen snow.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE
cut off
separated from other places, so that people can't reach you
Example: *After the storm, the village was cut off for three days.*

PROVERB
Many hands make light work.
A job is easier and faster when many people help.
Example: *Let's all clean the classroom together. Many hands make light work.*

IDIOM
a ray of hope
a small sign that things will get better
Example: *The doctor's words gave the family a ray of hope.*

The Night the River Rose (continued)

6 New words

roaring	making a very loud, deep noise	**poured**	flowed quickly and in large amounts
crowded	with too many people in a small space	**bandages**	long pieces of cloth that you put around a wound
buzzing	a low noise like the sound of a bee	**terrified**	very, very frightened

SCIENCE · LESSON 5

Why the Nile Floods

How rain on mountains far away fills a river in one of the driest places on Earth, and why the flood is both a gift and a danger.

Explain a natural process · Use inversion in formal writing · Talk about the good and bad sides of nature

1 Read

Every summer, the Nile rises. For thousands of years, the people along its banks have waited for this flood, and feared it. But why does a river in one of the driest parts of the world flood at all?

The answer lies far to the south and east, in the **Ethiopian Highlands**. From June to September, monsoon winds carry heavy rain from the Indian Ocean to these mountains. The water rushes down into the **Blue Nile**, which starts at Lake Tana, and into other rivers like the Atbara. Only in these months does the Blue Nile become a giant.

The **White Nile**, which comes from the great lakes of East Africa, is very different. Its water travels slowly through huge swamps in South Sudan, where much of it is lost to the sun. Rarely does it rise quickly. The two rivers meet at Khartoum, and in the flood season, most of the water that reaches Egypt comes from Ethiopia.

Why the Nile Floods (continued)

1 Read (continued)

For farmers, the flood has always been **a double-edged sword**. It leaves behind **silt**, a rich, dark soil that makes the fields green, and people in ancient times even built stone steps to measure the river and predict the harvest. But the flood can also destroy. In 2020, the Blue Nile at Khartoum reached its highest level in more than a hundred years, and thousands of homes were **swept away**.

Today, dams like the Roseires Dam in Sudan and the Aswan High Dam in Egypt control much of the flood. They store water and make electricity. But no dam can control the rain. As the climate changes, scientists warn that heavy floods may come more often, so cities along the river need better plans, stronger homes, and early warnings.

2 Where the flood water comes from

June to September
monsoon rain on the Ethiopian Highlands

Blue Nile
brings most of the flood water

White Nile
slower, loses water in the swamps

Khartoum
where the two rivers meet

DID YOU KNOW? After they meet at Khartoum, the Blue Nile and the White Nile flow side by side for a while, and from the bridges you can see their two different colors.

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Where does the flood water come from?**
The Ethiopian Highlands.

2 **When does the heavy rain fall?**
From June to September.

3 **Where does the Blue Nile start?**
At Lake Tana.

4 **Why does the White Nile rarely rise quickly?**
Its water travels through huge swamps, where much of it is lost to the sun.

Why the Nile Floods (continued)

3 Questions and answers (continued)

5 Where do the two rivers meet?
At Khartoum.

6 What is silt?
A rich, dark soil that the flood leaves behind.

7 What happened in 2020?
The Blue Nile at Khartoum reached its highest level in more than a hundred years.

8 What do dams do?
They store water, make electricity, and control much of the flood.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

a double-edged sword

something that has both good and bad results

Example: *Social media is a double-edged sword. It connects us, but it also wastes our time.*

PHRASE

be swept away

to be carried away by fast water or wind

Example: *During the storm, several boats were swept away.*

5 New words

banks	the land along the sides of a river	**monsoon**	a wind that brings heavy rain in summer
swamps	areas of soft, wet land	**predict**	say what will happen in the future
harvest	the time when farmers collect their crops	**warnings**	messages that tell people about a danger

CONVERSATION · LESSON 6

Asking for More Time

Making a formal request and agreeing on a compromise

Make a formal request | Explain your reasons | Accept a compromise

1 Read the conversation

After the flood, Sara is late with her final report. She goes to see her professor, Dr. Malik.

SARA	Good morning, Dr. Malik. Do you have a moment?
DR. MALIK	Of course, Sara. Come in. How is the village after the flood?
SARA	Everyone is safe, thank you. But that's actually why I'm here. I was wondering whether it would be possible to have more time for my final report.
DR. MALIK	I see. The deadline is this Thursday. How much time do you need?
SARA	Would two weeks be acceptable? I spent five days helping in the village, and I've **fallen behind** with my data.
DR. MALIK	Two weeks is a lot. Could you finish in ten days if I gave you the data from last year's project?
SARA	That would really help. Not only would I save time, but I could also compare the two years.
DR. MALIK	Then ten days it is. Send me a short plan by Sunday, so I know you're on track.
SARA	Thank you so much. That's **a weight off my shoulders**.
DR. MALIK	You did something important in that village, Sara. Now go and write about it.

2 Useful phrases

ASK FOR A MOMENT
Do you have a moment?

MAKE A FORMAL REQUEST
I was wondering whether it would be possible to have more time.

EXPLAIN THE REASON
I spent five days helping in the village.

SUGGEST AN AMOUNT
Would two weeks be acceptable?

ACCEPT A COMPROMISE
That would really help.

THANK SOMEONE WARMLY
Thank you so much.

Asking for More Time (continued)

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

fall behind

to do less than you should by a certain time

Example: *I was sick for a week, and I fell behind with my homework.*

IDIOM

a weight off your shoulders

the feeling of relief when a worry goes away

Example: *When I paid back the money, it was a weight off my shoulders.*

4 New words

report	a piece of writing about what you have studied or found	**deadline**	the last day or time to finish something
acceptable	good enough to agree to	**data**	facts and numbers that you collect
compare	look at two things to see how they are different	**on track**	doing what you planned to do

STORY · LESSON 7

The App That Went Wrong

Omar's new app for farmers goes live and sends the wrong prices to everyone. Read the story, then read it from the point of view of his youngest engineer.

Use conditionals without if | Talk about mistakes and responsibility | Tell a story about a crisis at work

1 The story

For six months, Omar's team had been building FarmPrice, an app that tells farmers the latest prices in the big markets, so that nobody can cheat them. **Should** the price of onions **rise** in Omdurman, a farmer two hundred kilometers away **will know** within minutes.

The launch was planned for Monday. On Sunday night, Amir, the youngest engineer, asked for one more week of testing. Omar said no. The radio had already announced the launch, and three hundred farmers were waiting. **Look before you leap**, Amir thought, but he said nothing.

The App That Went Wrong (continued)

1 The story (continued)

At nine o'clock on Monday, FarmPrice went live. By ten, the phones were ringing. A farmer in Gezira had sold his tomatoes for half their price, because the app said that the market price had fallen. Another had driven to Khartoum to sell onions at a price that didn't exist. By lunchtime, the news had **spread like wildfire** on social media.

Omar couldn't find the problem, and neither could his team. Then, at four o'clock, he got a message from Huda. "My students think they've found your mistake," it said. Huda had been using the app in her class to teach numbers and prices, and a nine-year-old girl had noticed that it was mixing up the price of one kilo with the price of a whole box.

The team fixed it in twenty minutes. **Had** they **tested** the app for one more week, they **would have found** the mistake themselves. **Were it not for** a class of nine-year-olds, it **might have taken** days.

That evening, Omar did the hardest thing he had ever done in business. He went on the radio and **owned up to** the mistake. "**Had I listened** to my youngest engineer," he said, "this **would never have happened**. **Should** any farmer **have lost** money today, my company will pay it back."

A month later, FarmPrice had five thousand users, more than Omar had ever hoped for. "People forgive mistakes," Mr. Ali told him. "What they don't forgive is hiding them." And at Huda's school, a nine-year-old girl now has a certificate on her wall. It says Chief Tester.

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What does FarmPrice do?**
It tells farmers the latest prices in the big markets.

2 **When was the launch planned?**
For Monday.

3 **What did Amir ask for?**
One more week of testing.

The App That Went Wrong (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

4 Why did Omar say no?
The radio had already announced the launch, and three hundred farmers were waiting.

5 What happened to the farmer in Gezira?
He sold his tomatoes for half their price.

6 How did the news travel?
It spread like wildfire on social media.

7 Who sent Omar a message at four o'clock?
Huda.

8 What had a nine-year-old girl noticed?
The app was mixing up the price of one kilo with the price of a whole box.

9 How long did it take to fix the mistake?
Twenty minutes.

10 What did Omar do on the radio?
He owned up to the mistake.

11 What did he promise?
That his company would pay back any farmer who had lost money.

12 What does the girl's certificate say?
Chief Tester.

3 Point of view Now Amir tells it.

AM

On Sunday night, I asked Omar for one more week. **Had he said** yes, we **would have found** the mistake ourselves. But the radio had already announced the launch, and **were I** in his place, I might have done the same.

On Monday, I watched our phones ring all day. Every call was a farmer who had lost money because of our app, and I felt sick.

When Huda's message arrived, I read it three times. A child had found in one afternoon what six engineers had missed for six months.

What I will remember most, though, is Omar on the radio. He didn't blame me, and he didn't blame the code. He said that it was his decision. **Should** I ever **start** my own company, I will try to be that kind of boss.

The App That Went Wrong (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned conditionals without if.

In formal English, we can drop if and put had, should, or were first. The meaning doesn't change.

WITH IF	WITHOUT IF
If they had tested it, …	**Had they tested** it, …
If I had listened, …	**Had I listened**, …
If any farmer has lost money, …	**Should any farmer have lost** money, …
If I were in his place, …	**Were I** in his place, …
If it weren't for the children, …	**Were it not for** the children, …

Had = if + past perfect
Had I known, I would have come.

Should = if, for a possible future
Should you need help, call me.

Were = if + were
Were I you, I would wait.

QUESTIONS **What would you have done, had you been Omar?**

Had I been Omar, I would have waited one more week.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PROVERB

Look before you leap.

Think carefully about the results before you do something.

Example: *Don't sign the contract today. Read it first. Look before you leap.*

IDIOM

spread like wildfire

to travel very quickly from person to person

Example: *The news of the free concert spread like wildfire.*

PHRASE

own up to

to admit that you did something wrong

Example: *Nobody owned up to breaking the window.*

The App That Went Wrong (continued)

6 New words

cheat	get something from someone in a way that is not honest	**launch**	the day a new product is first offered to people
announced	told everyone in public	**users**	people who use a product or a service
certificate	an official paper that says you have done something	**blame**	say that someone is responsible for something bad

PODCAST · LESSON 8

Can You Believe What You Read Online?

A newspaper reporter explains why fake news spreads so fast, and how to check a story before you share it.

Follow a podcast discussion · Talk about fake news · Use should and had without if

1 Before you listen

? Have you ever shared something online and then found out that it wasn't true?
? How do you decide whether a news story is real?

2 Listen and read

The Future Vision Podcast · Episode 24

Hosts: Sara and Adam · Guest: Rania Hamid, a reporter at The Daily Nile

00:05	SARA	Welcome to The Future Vision Podcast. I'm Sara.
00:08	ADAM	And I'm Adam. Today we're talking about fake news. Our guest is Rania Hamid, a reporter at The Daily Nile. Welcome, Rania!
00:16	RANIA	Thank you. Actually, Sara and I have met before, at a conference in Cairo.
00:21	SARA	The one where I lost my laptop! So, Rania, why does fake news spread so fast?
00:27	RANIA	Because it's designed to make us feel something, like fear, anger, or surprise. A shocking story can go viral in an hour, long before anyone checks it.

Can You Believe What You Read Online? (continued)

2 Listen and read (continued)

00:39	ADAM	Last month, my uncle sent me a message saying that bananas cure headaches. He'd shared it with forty people.
00:47	RANIA	That's a perfect example. **Had he checked** one good source, he **would have found** that it wasn't true.
00:55	SARA	So what should we do?
00:57	RANIA	Three things. First, look at the source. Who wrote it, and when? Second, **should you see** a shocking headline, read the whole article before you share it. And third, **take it with a pinch of salt** if no other news website is reporting it.
01:16	ADAM	What about photos and videos? They look so real.
01:20	RANIA	They can be old, or changed with software. **Were I** a student today, I'd learn how to search for a photo online and see where it first appeared.
01:33	SARA	Have you ever been fooled yourself?
01:36	RANIA	Once, early in my career. I almost published a story about a lion in a Khartoum market. Luckily, my editor asked me to find one person who had actually seen it. Nobody had.
01:50	ADAM	A lion in the market! I would have shared that.
01:53	RANIA	That's exactly the problem. The best stories are often the ones we should check twice.
02:00	SARA	Rania, thank you so much. That's all for today. Next week, we're talking about the future of farming. See you then!

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Who is the guest?**
Rania Hamid, a reporter at The Daily Nile.

2 **Where had Sara and Rania met before?**
At a conference in Cairo.

3 **Why does fake news spread so fast?**
It's designed to make us feel something, like fear, anger, or surprise.

4 **What did Adam's uncle share?**
A message saying that bananas cure headaches.

Can You Believe What You Read Online? (continued)

3 Questions and answers (continued)

5 What should you do if you see a shocking headline?
Read the whole article before you share it.

6 What would Rania learn if she were a student today?
How to search for a photo online and see where it first appeared.

7 What story did Rania almost publish?
A story about a lion in a Khartoum market.

8 Which stories should we check twice?
The best stories.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

go viral

to be shared very quickly by a lot of people online

Example: *Her video of the cat went viral, and a million people watched it.*

IDIOM

take something with a pinch of salt

to not completely believe something

Example: *He says he met a famous actor, but I take his stories with a pinch of salt.*

5 New words

fake	not real or true
source	the place or person that information comes from
fooled	tricked into believing something false
shocking	very surprising in a bad way
cure	make an illness go away
published	printed or put online for people to read

STORY · LESSON 9

Two Offers

Adam gets two job offers on the same day, one far away and one at home. Read the story, then read it from his grandfather's point of view.

- Talk about wishes and regrets
- Say what you would rather someone did
- Talk about a difficult choice

1 The story

On the same Tuesday, Adam received two emails. The first was from a large airline in the Gulf. They were offering him a place as a junior pilot, with a salary five times bigger than anything in Sudan, and the chance to fly some of the biggest planes in the world. The second was from Sudan's national airline. The salary was small, and the planes were old, but the job was in Khartoum.

"It's the chance of a lifetime," said Omar. "If you don't go, I'll go for you." Sara wasn't so sure. "I'd rather you stayed," she said honestly. "But I'd rather you were happy there than unhappy here."

For a week, Adam couldn't sleep. Every night, he sat at his desk and tried to weigh up the two offers on a piece of paper. Money, planes, and experience on one side. Family, friends, and the Nile on the other. "I wish I could be in two places at once," he told Huda. "If only someone would make the decision for me."

Finally, he went to see Mr. Ali. He knew the story of the bank job in Dubai, and he expected his old teacher to tell him to stay. Instead, Mr. Ali surprised him. "My choice was right for me," he said. "It doesn't have to be right for you. It's time you stopped asking other people and asked yourself."

Then Adam went to his grandparents' house. His grandfather listened quietly. "When I left for Cairo in 1975," he said, "I wished every day that I hadn't gone. But I came back a better engineer, and your grandmother waited. Home is where the heart is, Adam. If your heart is here, it will bring you back."

Two Offers (continued)

1 The story (continued)

That night, Adam made his decision. He would fly in the Gulf for five years, learn everything he could, and then come home to fly for Sudan. He called the national airline and asked if they would hold a place for him. "**We'd rather** you **started** now," the manager said. "But we'll be waiting."

At the airport, his grandmother gave him a small envelope. Inside was the letter from 1975. "Keep it," she said. "It reminds us that some people are worth coming back for."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How many emails did Adam receive?**
Two.

2 **What was the first offer?**
A place as a junior pilot at a large airline in the Gulf.

3 **What was good about the second offer?**
The job was in Khartoum.

4 **What did Omar say?**
It's the chance of a lifetime.

5 **What did Sara say?**
She'd rather he stayed, but she'd rather he was happy there than unhappy here.

6 **What did Adam write on one side of the paper?**
Money, planes, and experience.

7 **What did Adam wish?**
That he could be in two places at once.

8 **What did he expect Mr. Ali to tell him?**
To stay.

9 **What did Mr. Ali tell him?**
It was time he stopped asking other people and asked himself.

10 **What did his grandfather say about home?**
Home is where the heart is.

11 **What did Adam decide?**
To fly in the Gulf for five years and then come home to fly for Sudan.

12 **What did his grandmother give him at the airport?**
The letter from 1975.

Two Offers (continued)

3 Point of view

Now Adam's grandfather tells it.

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When Adam came to see me, he looked exactly like I did in 1975, young, excited, and afraid. He **wished** someone **would tell** him what to do.

I didn't tell him. **I'd rather** he **made** his own mistakes than lived with mine. But I told him the truth. Leaving was the hardest thing I ever did, and it was also the best.

I wish I **had written** more letters home when I was in Cairo. I hope Adam writes more than I did.

When Amna gave him the letter at the airport, I had to look away. **It's high time** I **stopped** crying at airports. I am seventy-one years old.

4 What did you learn?

You learned wish, if only, would rather, and it's time.

We use them to talk about what we want to be different. After them, we often use a past form, even when we mean now.

FORM	EXAMPLE
I wish + past: about now	I wish I **could be** in two places.
I wish + past perfect: a regret	I wish I **had written** more letters.
If only … would	If only someone **would decide** for me!
I'd rather + person + past	I'd rather you **stayed**.
It's time + person + past	It's time you **stopped** asking others.

Two Offers (continued)

4 What did you learn? (continued)

A past form with a present meaning
I'd rather you stayed means: I want you to stay now.

I'd rather + verb, for yourself
I'd rather fly for Sudan. I'd rather you flew for Sudan.

It's high time is stronger
It's high time we left. We are very late.

QUESTIONS **What do you wish you could change about your city?**

I wish there were more parks.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM
the chance of a lifetime
a very good opportunity that you will probably never get again
Example: *Studying at that famous school was the chance of a lifetime.*

PHRASE
weigh up
to think carefully about the good and bad sides before you decide
Example: *Before buying the car, she weighed up the price and the cost of the fuel.*

PROVERB
Home is where the heart is.
Your real home is the place where the people you love are.
Example: *She has lived in three countries, but she always says that home is where the heart is.*

6 New words

junior	at a low level in a job because you are new	**national**	belonging to the whole country
experience	knowledge and skill that you get from doing something	**hold**	keep something for someone until later
reminds	makes someone remember something	**worth**	good or important enough for something

NEWS · LESSON 10

More Graduates Look for Work Abroad

Read a news report about young people leaving to work in other countries, and the ones who plan to come back.

Read an education report | Find who, what, where, when, and why | Notice it's time and would rather in formal English

1 Read the article

THE DAILY NILE Sunday, June 14

More Young Graduates Look for Work Abroad

A new survey shows that four in ten graduates plan to leave the country, but many say that they would rather come home later.

BY OUR EDUCATION REPORTER

Four in ten young graduates are planning to work abroad, according to a new survey of two thousand students in their final year. Most of them hope to find jobs in the Gulf, in Europe, or in other African countries.

The main reason, the survey found, is money. Many graduates say that salaries at home are too low to make ends meet, especially in medicine, engineering, and technology. "I love my country," said one medical student, "but I have to think about my family."

Experts have long warned about the brain drain, the loss of skilled people to other countries. "Every doctor who leaves is a hospital that waits longer," said a professor of medicine. "**It is time** the government **made** it easier for young people to stay."

> *"Every doctor who leaves is a hospital that waits longer."*
>
> A PROFESSOR OF MEDICINE

But the survey also found some good news. More than half of the graduates who plan to leave say that they **would rather come** back within ten years, bringing new skills and experience with them. Some companies are already trying to attract them home. One airline, for example, has started to hold places for young pilots who train abroad.

More Graduates Look for Work Abroad (continued)

1 Read the article (continued)

"Leaving is not always a loss," said a young engineer who returned last year after five years in Germany. "I learned things there that I could never have learned here. Now I'm teaching them to others."

2 The five key facts

Who?	What?	Where?	When?	Why?
young graduates in their final year	four in ten plan to work abroad	the Gulf, Europe, and other African countries	a new survey this year	low salaries at home

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How many graduates plan to work abroad?**
Four in ten.

2 **Where do most of them hope to work?**
In the Gulf, in Europe, or in other African countries.

3 **What is the main reason?**
Money. Salaries at home are too low.

4 **What is the brain drain?**
The loss of skilled people to other countries.

5 **What does the professor say it is time for?**
For the government to make it easier for young people to stay.

6 **What would more than half of them rather do?**
Come back within ten years.

7 **What has one airline started to do?**
Hold places for young pilots who train abroad.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

make ends meet

to have just enough money for the things you need

Example: *With prices so high, many families find it hard to make ends meet.*

PHRASE

brain drain

when many educated or skilled people leave their country to work in another

Example: *The country lost many of its doctors to the brain drain.*

More Graduates Look for Work Abroad (continued)

5 New words

graduates	people who have finished university	**survey**	a set of questions that many people answer
skilled	trained to do a job well	**attract**	make someone want to come
loss	the act of losing something or someone	**returned**	came back

CONVERSATION · LESSON 11

Negotiating a Job Offer

Asking politely for better terms before you sign

Discuss the terms of a job offer | Make polite requests | Agree on a compromise

1 Read the conversation

Before he signs his contract, Adam talks to Ms. Layla, the head of training at the airline in the Gulf.

ML MS. LAYLA	Adam, we're very happy that you want to accept our offer. Do you have any questions before you sign?
A ADAM	Thank you. I'm excited to join you. There are just two things I'd like to discuss, if that's all right.
ML MS. LAYLA	Of course. Go ahead.
A ADAM	The first is the start date. The offer says September 1, but my final exams finish on September 10. Would you be open to a start date of October 1?
ML MS. LAYLA	Our training course begins in September, so that's difficult. Could you start on September 15? You would join the course one week late.
A ADAM	That works for me. Thank you for **meeting me halfway**.
ML MS. LAYLA	And the second thing?
A ADAM	The contract is for three years, but I'd rather sign for five. After that, I'd like to know whether I could leave without paying back the cost of my training.
ML MS. LAYLA	That's an unusual question, but a fair one. If you stay five years, we pay for all of your training. I'll put that in writing, and then **the ball is in your court**.
A ADAM	Then I'm ready to sign. Thank you, Ms. Layla.

Negotiating a Job Offer (continued)

2 Useful phrases

SAY YOU HAVE QUESTIONS
There are just two things I'd like to discuss, if that's all right.

MAKE A REQUEST
Would you be open to a start date of October 1?

ACCEPT A COMPROMISE
That works for me.

SAY WHAT YOU PREFER
I'd rather sign for five years.

ASK ABOUT A CONDITION
I'd like to know whether I could leave without paying back the cost.

CLOSE THE DEAL
Then I'm ready to sign.

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

meet someone halfway

to agree to part of what someone wants, so that you both get something

Example: *I wanted 100 pounds and he offered 60, so we met halfway at 80.*

IDIOM

the ball is in your court

it is your turn to decide or act

Example: *I've sent you my best price. Now the ball is in your court.*

4 New words

accept	say yes to something that is offered	**sign**	write your name on a paper to show you agree
discuss	talk about something with someone	**contract**	a written agreement between people or companies
unusual	different from what is normal	**fair**	right and reasonable

STORY · LESSON 12

The Last Lesson

After thirty years, Mr. Ali is teaching his last class. He hates being thanked, so his students find another way. Read the story, then read it from Mr. Ali's point of view.

- Use advanced passive forms
- Talk about memories and endings
- Say thank you in a meaningful way

1 The story

After thirty years, Mr. Ali's last day at the institute had come. He had asked for no party and no speeches, because Mr. Ali **hates being thanked**. "Teachers **are paid** to teach," he always said. "They don't need **to be thanked** for it."

So his students decided not to thank him, not with words, anyway. For two months, Huda and Sara had been secretly contacting people who **had been taught** by him over the years. They found more than two hundred.

On the last day, Mr. Ali walked into his classroom at eight o'clock, as usual, and stopped. The room was full. Doctors, farmers, engineers, shop owners, and teachers were sitting at the desks, and more were standing along the walls. On the board, someone had written one word. Future.

"**Having been taught** by you," said Dr. Amira, standing up, "we wanted to give you one more lesson. Today, you're the student." And one by one, they told him what they had learned from him. Not grammar, but other things. To ask questions. To be patient. To stop for people by the road. Omar said that one, and everyone laughed.

Mr. Ali tried to speak, but he had **a lump in his throat**. Then Adam, who **had been given** three days off by his new airline, stood up with a box. Inside were the letters that the class had written to their future selves. "You were supposed to post these in ten years," he said. "But we'd like you to read them now."

Mr. Ali read them all, slowly, while the room waited. Then he put them back in the box. "Every one of you has become what you wrote," he said quietly. "I **expected to be given** a cake today, not this."

The Last Lesson (continued)

1 The story (continued)

When he finally left the building, his students walked with him to the gate. "Will you miss it?" asked Sara. Mr. Ali smiled. "When I look back on these thirty years, I will remember faces, not lessons. All good things must come to an end. But that doesn't mean they stop being good."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How long had Mr. Ali been teaching at the institute?**
Thirty years.

2 **What had he asked for?**
No party and no speeches.

3 **Why doesn't he like being thanked?**
He says that teachers are paid to teach.

4 **What had Huda and Sara been doing for two months?**
Secretly contacting people who had been taught by him.

5 **How many did they find?**
More than two hundred.

6 **What did Mr. Ali see when he walked into his classroom?**
The room was full of his old students.

7 **What word was written on the board?**
Future.

8 **What did Dr. Amira say?**
Today, you're the student.

9 **What did Omar say he had learned?**
To stop for people by the road.

10 **What was inside Adam's box?**
The letters that the class had written to their future selves.

11 **What did Mr. Ali expect to be given?**
A cake.

12 **What will he remember when he looks back on these years?**
Faces, not lessons.

The Last Lesson (continued)

3 Point of view

Now Mr. Ali tells it.

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I **don't like being surprised**, and I **hate being thanked**. My students know both of these things, so of course they did both.

When I opened the door that morning, I saw thirty years of faces. Some of them I had taught as children, and now they **were being called** doctor and engineer by their own students.

Having been told for thirty years that teaching is a small job, I learned that day that it is not. Every person in that room **had been changed** by something small, a question, a word on a board, a little patience.

I am told that I will **be given** a pension and a quiet life. I would rather **be given** a new class. But perhaps it is time I learned something new myself.

4 What did you learn?

You learned advanced passive forms.

The passive can come after verbs and in other forms, not only after is and was.

FORM	EXAMPLE
being + past participle	He hates being thanked.
to be + past participle	They don't need to be thanked.
having been + past participle	Having been taught by you, we…
had been + past participle	People who had been taught by him came.
was / were being + past participle	They were being called doctor.

After like, hate, enjoy: being
I don't like being surprised.

After want, expect, need: to be
I expected to be given a cake.

Who did it? Add by
They had been taught by Mr. Ali.

QUESTIONS **Do you like being given advice?** I like being given advice by my parents.

The Last Lesson (continued)

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

have a lump in your throat

to feel that you are going to cry

Example: *When my sister got married, I had a lump in my throat.*

PHRASE

look back on something

to think about something that happened in the past

Example: *When I look back on my school days, I remember my friends most.*

PROVERB

All good things must come to an end.

Even the best times in life don't last forever.

Example: *The holiday was wonderful, but all good things must come to an end.*

6 New words

speeches	formal talks to a group of people	**secretly**	without other people knowing
contacting	calling or writing to someone	**owners**	people who have something that belongs to them
patience	the ability to wait or try again without getting angry	**pension**	money that you get every month after you stop working

CONVERSATION · LESSON 13

The Scholarship Interview

Answering a panel's questions about your plans for study

Explain your reasons for further study | Describe a research plan | Answer a difficult question calmly

1 Read the conversation

Huda has an interview for a scholarship to study a master's degree in education. Dr. Nabil and Dr. Amira are on the panel.

DR. NABIL	Good afternoon, Huda. Please sit down. Why do you want to study for a master's degree in education?
HUDA	Having taught for two years, I've realized how much I still don't know. I'd like to be given the chance to learn how children really learn, and bring it back to my school.
DR. AMIRA	What has been the most difficult part of your teaching so far?

The Scholarship Interview (continued)

1 Read the conversation (continued)

H HUDA	Children who are afraid to speak. What I've learned is that they don't need to be pushed. They need to be noticed.
DN DR. NABIL	And what would you research, were you given the scholarship?
H HUDA	How stories help shy children speak a new language. I've seen it happen in my own class, but I'd like to prove it properly.
DA DR. AMIRA	Some people say that research in education changes nothing in real classrooms. What do you think?
H HUDA	I understand why they say that, and I try to keep an open mind. But had I not tried new ideas, a boy in my class would still be hiding under his desk.
DN DR. NABIL	Thank you, Huda. We'll let you know within two weeks.
H HUDA	Thank you for your time. Studying here would be a dream come true.

2 Useful phrases

EXPLAIN YOUR REASON
Having taught for two years, I've realized how much I still don't know.

SAY WHAT YOU WOULD LIKE
I'd like to be given the chance to learn.

SHARE WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNED
What I've learned is that they need to be noticed.

DESCRIBE YOUR PLAN
I'd like to prove it properly.

ANSWER A DIFFICULT QUESTION
I understand why they say that, but…

END WARMLY
Studying here would be a dream come true.

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

keep an open mind

to be ready to listen to new ideas before you decide

Example: *I didn't like fish, but I kept an open mind and tried it.*

IDIOM

a dream come true

something that you have wanted for a very long time

Example: *Visiting Japan was a dream come true for my brother.*

The Scholarship Interview (continued)

4 New words

scholarship	money that is given to a student to pay for study
panel	a small group of people who ask questions and make a decision
research	careful study to find out new facts
master's degree	a university degree that you study for after your first degree
realized	understood something for the first time
properly	in the correct way